

# TidyTuesday Week 30

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Wednesday 22<sup>nd</sup> July, 2026

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# 1 Weekly Summary

## AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only recurring publication where a computer flings two unrelated economic datasets at each other and we all pretend to be surprised by the results. This week, our tireless robot pulled just two pairings, which is honestly a merciful workload for a project whose entire premise is manufacturing false hope. Let's dig in and feel some emotions about numbers that mean nothing.

Monday, July 21, gave us a truly inspired matchup: the Federal Reserve's holdings of medium-term Treasury securities versus a Consumer Price Index for services in the American South that has been discontinued since 2017 and boasts a FRED popularity rating of one. One. That is the loneliest number a data series can have, and we honored it by regressing it against the Fed's balance sheet. The raw regression came back with an R-squared of 0.77 and a p-value with more zeros after the decimal than I care to count, which in a less enlightened newsletter would trigger a champagne cork. But then we detrended it, stripped out the shared "everything drifts upward over decades" effect, and watched the R-squared deflate to 0.37 while the relationship politely flipped sign. Translation: the raw "connection" was mostly two lines wandering the same general direction like strangers who happen to be walking to the same bus stop. A textbook trend mirage, and exactly the kind of thing this project exists to point at and laugh.

Tuesday, July 22, however, is where I need you to sit down. We paired "Withdrawals from Income of Quasi-Corporations" – a phrase I refuse to believe is real – against the current-cost depreciation of nonresidential structures. The raw regression posted an R-squared of 0.98, which is the kind of number that makes you want to call your mother. And here's the genuinely annoying part: after detrending, it held. R-squared of 0.87, p-value still buried in scientific notation, coefficient barely budging from 0.42 to 0.40. That is not a mirage collapsing in the desert; that is a relationship standing there smugly, arms crossed, in both the raw and detrended versions. When two quirky, unpopular series both survive the trend-removal gauntlet, it's at least a little tempting to imagine a real thread – both are dollar-denominated measures of business and capital activity, so maybe they genuinely rise and fall with the same underlying economic tides. Or maybe not.

Because – and I cannot stress this enough – these pairings are chosen at random by a program with no theory, no hypothesis, and no dignity. Nothing here is a causal claim, a forecast, or a reason to move money. Spurious correlation isn't the occasional bug in this operation; it's the entire product line, lovingly hand-picked from FRED's forgotten basement. Tuesday's result is "interesting" only in the sense that it survived a slightly harder test than Monday's, and even that

just means we should be marginally less embarrassed to mention it at a party. See you next week, when the robot will almost certainly correlate cheese production with bond yields and we'll all act astonished again.

## 2 Date: 2026-07-21

### Series ID: TREAS1T5

This series is titled Assets: Securities Held Outright: U.S. Treasury Securities: Maturing in over 1 Year to 5 Years: Wednesday Level and has a frequency of Weekly, As of Wednesday. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2002-12-18 and the observation end date is 2026-07-15. The popularity of this series is 21.

### Series ID: CUURD300SAS

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in South - Size Class D (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1977-12-01 and the observation end date is 2017-12-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

## 2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

|                          |                        |                            |          |
|--------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|----------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_CUURD300SAS | <b>R-squared:</b>          | 0.774    |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                    | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | 0.765    |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares          | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | 82.38    |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Tue, 21 Jul 2026       | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | 3.15e-09 |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 13:11:10               | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | -104.86  |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 26                     | <b>AIC:</b>                | 213.7    |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 24                     | <b>BIC:</b>                | 216.2    |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                      |                            |          |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust              |                            |          |

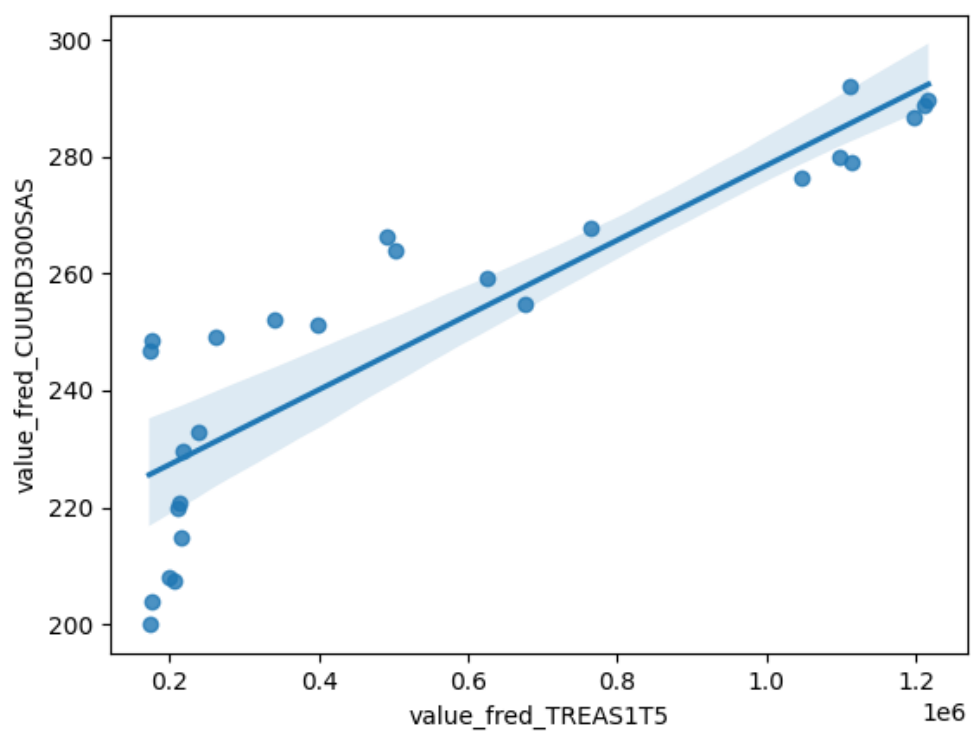
|                     | coef      | std err  | t      | P>  t | [0.025   | 0.975]   |
|---------------------|-----------|----------|--------|-------|----------|----------|
| const               | 214.5017  | 4.768    | 44.985 | 0.000 | 204.660  | 224.343  |
| value_fred_TREAS1T5 | 6.405e-05 | 7.06e-06 | 9.076  | 0.000 | 4.95e-05 | 7.86e-05 |

|                       |        |                          |          |
|-----------------------|--------|--------------------------|----------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | 1.003  | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | 0.294    |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | 0.606  | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | 0.795    |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | -0.004 | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | 0.672    |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | 2.143  | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 1.16e+06 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.



**Figure 1:** Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-21

[2] The condition number is large,  $1.16e+06$ . This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

## 2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

|                          |                                  |                            |         |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------|---------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_CUURD300SAS_detrended | <b>R-squared:</b>          | 0.365   |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                              | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | 0.339   |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares                    | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | 13.82   |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Tue, 21 Jul 2026                 | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | 0.00107 |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 13:11:11                         | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | -63.094 |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 26                               | <b>AIC:</b>                | 130.2   |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 24                               | <b>BIC:</b>                | 132.7   |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                                |                            |         |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust                        |                            |         |

|                                      | coef       | std err  | t        | P>  t | [0.025    | 0.975]    |
|--------------------------------------|------------|----------|----------|-------|-----------|-----------|
| <b>const</b>                         | 4.318e-12  | 0.559    | 7.72e-12 | 1.000 | -1.154    | 1.154     |
| <b>value_fred_TREAS1T5_detrended</b> | -1.309e-05 | 3.52e-06 | -3.718   | 0.001 | -2.04e-05 | -5.83e-06 |

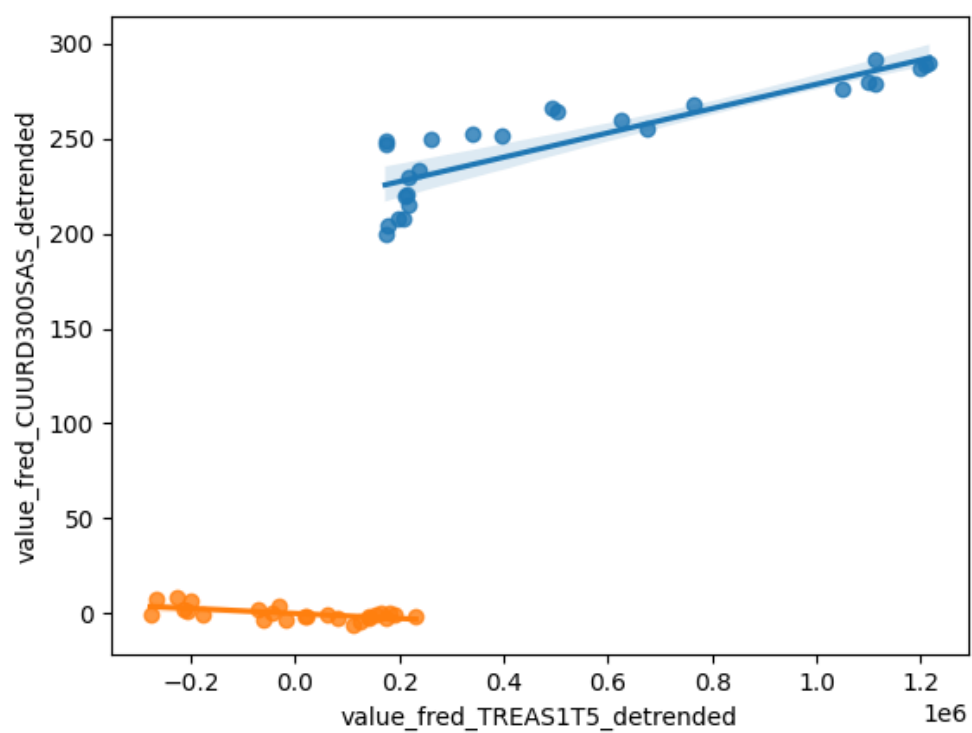
  

|                       |       |                          |          |
|-----------------------|-------|--------------------------|----------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | 0.194 | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | 1.006    |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | 0.907 | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | 0.403    |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | 0.028 | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | 0.818    |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | 2.393 | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 1.59e+05 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.59e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



**Figure 2:** Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-21

### 3 Date: 2026-07-22

#### Series ID: NNBICPA027N

This series is titled Nonfinancial Noncorporate Business; Withdrawals from Income of Quasi-Corporations, Paid, Transactions and has a frequency of Annual, End of Period. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1959-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

#### Series ID: M1YTOTL1ST000

This series is titled Current-Cost Depreciation of Private and government fixed assets: Nonresidential: Structures and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1925-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

### 3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

|                          |                          |                            |          |
|--------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------|----------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_M1YTOTL1ST000 | <b>R-squared:</b>          | 0.985    |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                      | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | 0.984    |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares            | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | 4111.    |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Wed, 22 Jul 2026         | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | 8.67e-60 |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 13:16:17                 | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | -777.64  |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 66                       | <b>AIC:</b>                | 1559.    |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 64                       | <b>BIC:</b>                | 1564.    |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                        |                            |          |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust                |                            |          |

|                        | coef       | std err  | t      | P>  t | [0.025    | 0.975]   |
|------------------------|------------|----------|--------|-------|-----------|----------|
| const                  | -1720.1069 | 5808.925 | -0.296 | 0.768 | -1.33e+04 | 9884.554 |
| value_fred_NNBICPA027N | 0.4156     | 0.006    | 64.115 | 0.000 | 0.403     | 0.429    |

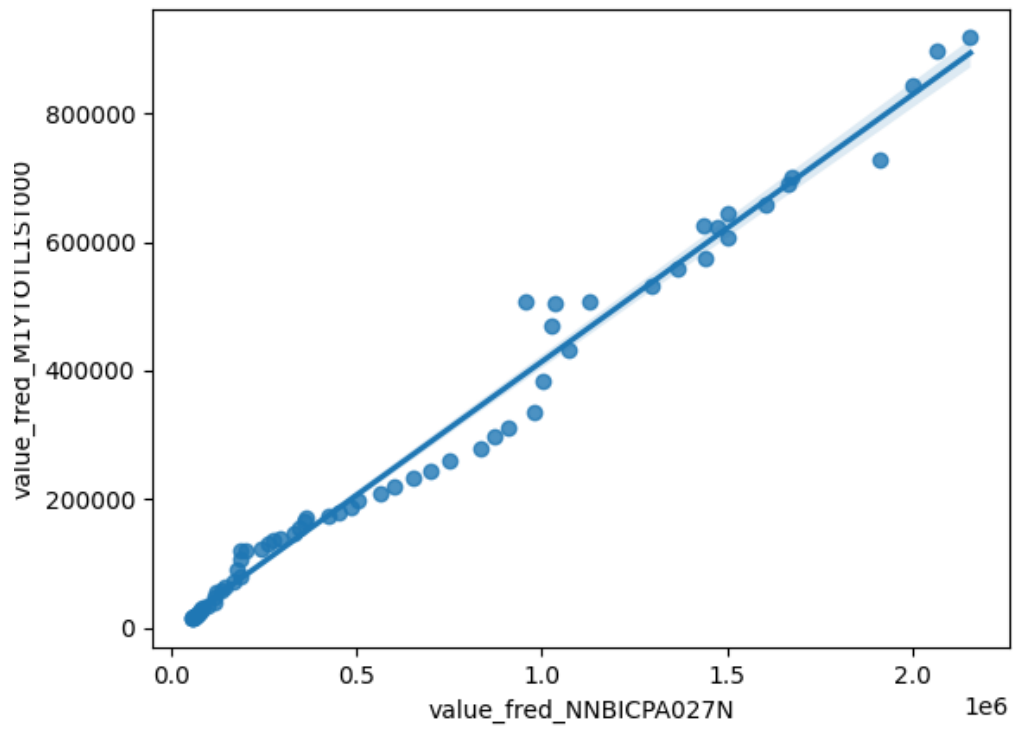
  

|                       |       |                          |          |
|-----------------------|-------|--------------------------|----------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | 7.252 | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | 0.477    |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | 0.027 | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | 10.958   |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | 0.289 | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | 0.00417  |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | 4.911 | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 1.31e+06 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.





**Figure 3:** Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-22

[2] The condition number is large,  $1.31e+06$ . This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

### 3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

|                          |                                    |                            |          |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_M1YTOTL1ST000_detrended | <b>R-squared:</b>          | 0.873    |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                                | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | 0.871    |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares                      | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | 439.3    |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Wed, 22 Jul 2026                   | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | 2.31e-30 |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 13:16:17                           | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | -777.37  |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 66                                 | <b>AIC:</b>                | 1559.    |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 64                                 | <b>BIC:</b>                | 1563.    |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                                  |                            |          |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust                          |                            |          |

|                                         | coef      | std err  | t        | P>  t | [0.025    | 0.975]   |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------|----------|----------|-------|-----------|----------|
| <b>const</b>                            | 2.698e-09 | 3943.730 | 6.84e-13 | 1.000 | -7878.507 | 7878.507 |
| <b>value_fred_NNBICPA027N_detrended</b> | 0.4024    | 0.019    | 20.960   | 0.000 | 0.364     | 0.441    |

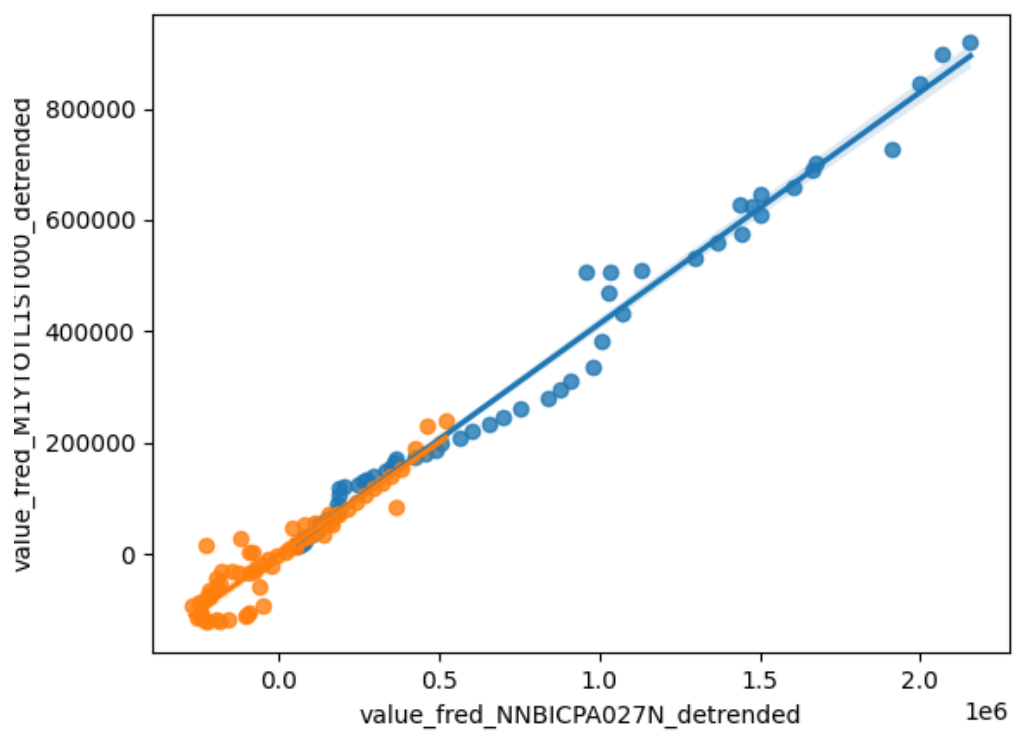
  

|                       |       |                          |          |
|-----------------------|-------|--------------------------|----------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | 5.762 | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | 0.463    |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | 0.056 | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | 8.362    |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | 0.128 | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | 0.0153   |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | 4.725 | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 2.05e+05 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.05e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



**Figure 4:** Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-22